Data availability

Chemical
pH (1:5)
E.C. (mS/cm)
Macronutrients (N,Ca, P...)
Micronutrients (Fe,Mb,Cu...)
Active Calcium
Carbonates (% CO_3)
CEC (meq/100g)
Heavy metals

Biological
Organic Matter (%)
C/N Ratio
Organic carbon (%)
Nematoda P/A
Fungi P/A

Physical
Clays (%)
Silts (%)
Sands (%)
Texture

Risks

Drought and heat can make it hard to establish covers or force growers to end them early, so the programme leans into what works in dry years: drought tolerant mixes, flexible sowing and termination windows, and moisture saving tactics such as rolling and mulch to keep limited water in the soil. When late cold snaps arrive, spring frosts may dictate unusual ground operations; the rules reflect that reality and allow pragmatic derogations so farms do not lose eligibility for acting on seasonal needs.



Preliminary results

On Rueda's gravelly sands, gains are incremental but durable: higher SOC in the surface horizon, better aggregation/infiltration, fewer bare-soil days in windy or storm-prone windows, and more stable yields and must quality under heat. Economically, holdings stack a predictable public base with small but reliable top-ups, while saving on inputs through composted by-products and shared kit. Institutionally, the case shows how IP certification + eco-schemes + light, result-based MRV can be woven into a coherent, low-friction offer that is credible to buyers, workable for administrators and usable for growers.

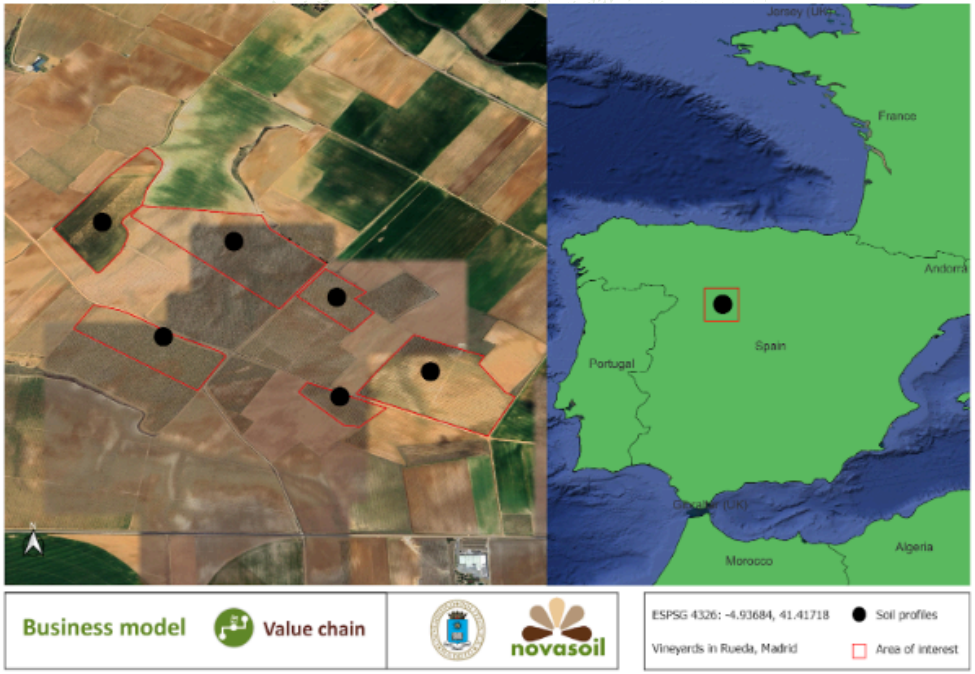
Economic perspective

On the market side, swings in grape prices and the thinness of voluntary credit demand are steadied by a public payment floor, explicit cost coverage for the results layer, and, where buyers value stewardship, multi year offtake that smooths income. The action-based base comes from eco-schemes/AECM and supports the predictable cost of covers, reduced tillage and biodiversity strips; IP certification anchors market access and signals quality. On top, a result-based top-up pays for delivered outcomes: fewer bare-soil days across the risk season, SOC increases (or maintenance of good status) and demonstrably lower erosion exposure on sensitive blocks. Because wineries already generate pomace and prunings, composting/chipping reduces purchased inputs; co-op procurement and shared machinery keep unit costs down.

Policy and governance

The policy framework ensures credibility and lowers entry barriers for farmers. Under the CAP, regional authorities and paying agencies provide the basic compliance floor through eco-schemes and AECM, while co-financing baselines and MRV set-up in the initial seasons. Compliance is safeguarded by multiple regulatory bodies: Integrated Production is verified by its control authority, GAEC standards establish rules on soil cover and tillage on slopes, and nitrates regulations further define obligations in vulnerable zones.

Organic vineyards in integrated production



NOVASOIL

The NOVASOIL project aims to show the benefits for society and the environment of investing in soil health.

The main output of the project will be a tool to analyse the suitability of different business cases that promote soil health.

This tool will be based on best practice examples in Europe and other countries, as well as on the needs and demands of society.

Organic vineyards

Summarize



This is a contractual solution to the value chain, whereby the winery Herederos del Marqués de Riscal, S.A. (hereinafter referred to as Riscal) purchases only organic grapes to produce two selected varieties: MARQUÉS DE RISCAL ORGANIC and MARQUÉS DE RISCAL SAUVIGNON BLANC ORGANIC.

In the Rueda case study, the growers are not associated, but they are integrated into the value chain by complying with the winery's standards, undergoing regular quality and residue controls and following a strict protocol of high quality organic production.

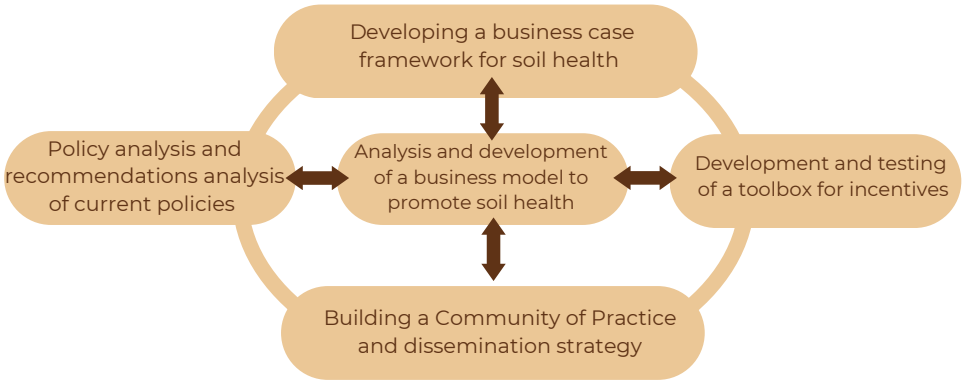


Figure 1. Structure of the NOVASOIL project

Case studies properties

Potential inhibitors

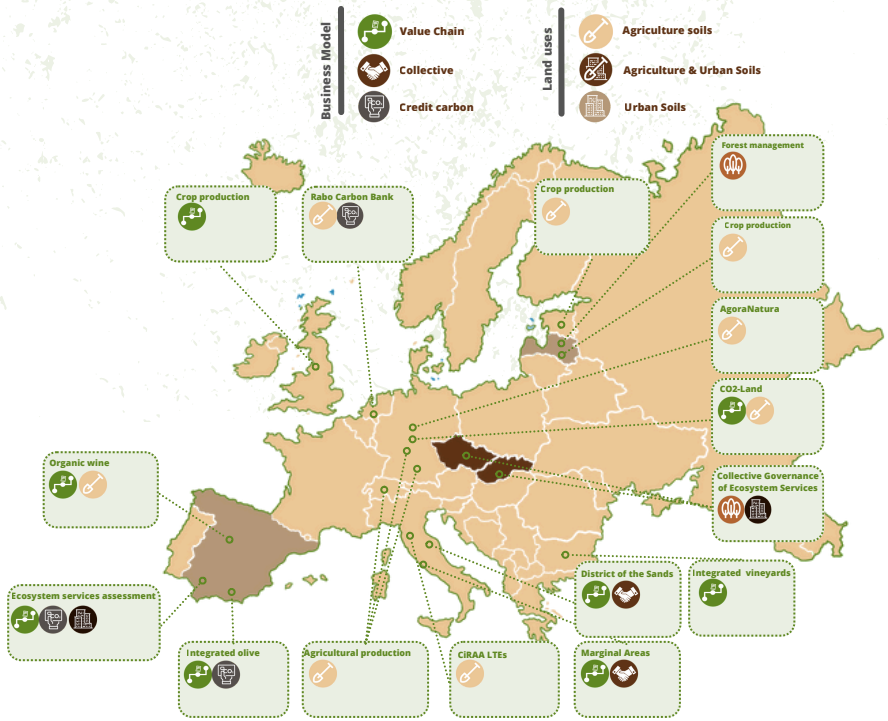
Water scarcity, declining financial support from the CAP, frost and future weather forecasts, the need for labour and the importance of organic production as a profitable and sustainable alternative.

Potential enablers

Organic production is a profitable and sustainable alternative in the Rueda region, which is increasingly attractive to consumers and in high demand for export.

Potential stakeholders

Grape producers, consumers, exporters, workers and employees, winegrowers, local and regional agricultural and environmental authorities and regulators.





Specific objectives

SO1 Multi-dimensional portfolio development of business cases and good examples for investing in soil health in Europe and beyond.

SO2 Analysis of current models around the world for creating new incentives and new revenues from healthy soils.

SO3 Apply a co-development approach to modelling that promotes soil health.

SO4 Develop a prototype incentive toolbox and test network.

SO5 Analysis of current policies and technologies related to soil health and income provision for farmers.

SO6 Developing a community of practice around investors and key soil health actors.

SO7 Increase interest in soil health through a digital marketing strategy plan

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NOVASOIL

INNOVATIVE BUSINESS MODELS FOR SOIL HEALTH

https://novasoil-project.eu

